

Military

Aim: Win battles, gain Command, and convert momentum into movement and control.
Resource: Command, maximum 2. Gain 1 the first time each turn Military wins a battle.
Faction Actions: None. Orders are Faction Abilities at their printed timings.
Victory: Run the Gauntlet.
General: attacks repeatedly and carries momentum forward. **Commandant:** defends controlled ground and turns defensive wins into pressure.
Recommended first Leader: General. **Starter:** Forward Doctrine.

FIRST-TURN PLAN

Establish your movement line, preserve a useful Gambit, and look for the first battle that can begin the Command loop.

OPPONENT SUMMARY

Track Command. Military can add movement, modify battle totals, extend a retreat, or advance its Front Line after a win. Invasion can enlarge an attacking Reserve and Tactic limit, but its unused movement ends when a pending battle is created.

Diplomats

Aim: Offer Terms, ratify different Proposals, and reshape battles through agreement or refusal.
Resource: Influence, 0-10; begin with 1.
Procedure: Offer Terms during a pending battle before Onset. Use Leverage before dice after refused Terms.
Victory: Peace Treaty after five different Proposals are ratified.
Ambassador: gains card flow from accepted Terms. **Senator:** risks larger Stakes and preserves Influence after setbacks.
Recommended first Leader: Ambassador. **Starter:** Open Channels.

FIRST-TURN PLAN

Build enough Influence to make refusal costly, then offer a Proposal whose accepted and refused results both advance your plan.

OPPONENT SUMMARY

Read the Proposal before accepting or refusing. Accepted Terms prevent the battle; refusal proceeds to Onset. Newly ratified Proposals grant Influence. Détente rewards acceptance only when the Proposal was already ratified when offered.

Financiers

Aim: Build Capital and Treasury value, buy Deeds, and combine ownership with territorial pressure.

Resource: Capital; begin with 2.

Faction Actions: Treasury, Deed purchase, Play the Market, and Hostile Takeover during Denouement.

Ability: Subsidize before dice. Financial Capacity may permit one Action in Opening and one in Denouement when one is a Financier Faction Action.

Victory: Own the Deeds to every Territory through Controlling Interest.

Banker: uses cards as controlled collateral. **Executive:** converts offensive Occupation into ownership and control.

Recommended first Leader: Executive. **Starter:** Hostile Expansion.

OPPONENT SUMMARY

Capital, Treasury, and Deeds are public. Financial Capacity may give both Action phases, but at least one Action must be a Financier Faction Action. Deed ownership does not itself equal Territory control.

Intelligence

Aim: Complete Missions, gain Intel and Operation Progress, and prepare a Special Operation.

Resources: Intel and Operation Progress.

Faction Actions: Start, complete, or abort a Mission; start or complete a Special Operation, all during Denouement.

Abilities: Surveillance, Interference, Fieldcraft, and Mission Control at their stated timings.

Victory: Complete a ready Special Operation.

Ranger: uses Fieldcraft and terrain knowledge. **Spymaster:** chains Missions through Mission Control.

Recommended first Leader: Ranger. **Starter:** Field Operations.

OPPONENT SUMMARY

Mission identity is hidden, but Intel and Operation Progress are public. Intelligence may inspect and interfere with a face-down Gambit and later face-down Tactics. Replacements do not create a new information window.

Faction Teaching Cards

Mystics

Aim: Complete three Rites, unlock faction abilities, then complete the Ritual of Ascendance.

Progression: Three public Rites; no resource tracker.

Faction Actions: Begin a Rite or begin the Ritual during Denouement. Nature's Altar may permit Begin a Rite during Opening.

Victory: Initiate and win a battle while the three Ritual cards remain bound.

Alchemist: replaces deliberate sacrifice with card flow. **Spirit Walker:** protects Rite and Ritual progress after a loss.

Recommended first Leader: Spirit Walker. **Starter:** Unbroken Circle.

FIRST-TURN PLAN

Choose the Rite that best fits your opening cards. Keep Arcane value available if the Spirit Walker may need to prevent interruption.

OPPONENT SUMMARY

Completed Rites and face-up bound cards are public. The Spirit Walker may sacrifice Arcane value 1, 2, 3, or 4 according to progress. Nature's Altar requires token presence to begin and control at completion timing for its same-turn exception.

Inquisition

Aim: Build Conviction, move opposing cards permanently into the Graveyard, and use Purge to remove options.

Resource: Conviction, maximum 4.

Faction Action: Purge during Opening or Denouement. A Purge Action permits one Action in each phase when one is Purge.

Abilities: Condemnation, Blasphemy, Final Judgment, and Relentless Pursuit.

Victory: Purification when the opponent cannot make the normal start-of-turn draw because both Draw Pile and Discard Pile are empty.

Grand Inquisitor: converts wins into discounted **Witch Hunter:** punishes failed attacks with pursuit. Purges.

Recommended first Leader: Grand Inquisitor. **Starter:** Final Judgment.

OPPONENT SUMMARY

Opposing Tactics normally go to the Graveyard in battles against Inquisition. Track Conviction before playing Arcane cards or attacking the Witch Hunter. Martyrdom does not prevent a loss, but it can send cards remaining in the winner's Reserve to the Graveyard.